Lesson 11: Forms

11.1 Introduction to Forms

A form is a web page which uses HTML form elements. Form elements provide a convenient method to collect user input through a web page.

11.2 Basic Form elements

The <FORM>…</FORM> element is used to define the start and end of a form in a document. There can be several forms on a page; however forms should not be nested. The <FORM> element has two attributes:

1. ACTION ; This attribute defines the URL of the program that will receive and process the data submitted on the form. All forms need to be linked to a program in order that their data can be processed.
2. METHOD; This attribute defines the method in which the data will be transmitted to the server. METHOD can take one of these values POST or GET. With the default method being GET.

Format: <FORM METHOD=POST|GET ACTION=”name and location”>
</FORM>

Example 1

Example of Form

```
<HTML>
 <HEAD><!—Example of form element-->
 </HEAD>
<BODY>
   <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION=“location and file name”>
This is a blank form!
   </FORM>
</BODY>
</HTML>
```

11.3 Basic Form Input

HTML provides a number of different form fields who’s contents can be edited by the user. The <INPUT> element is used to specify the majority of these. <INPUT> elements have an attribute value which can be one of the following types:

i. CHECKBOX
ii. HIDDEN
iii. PASSWORD
iv. RADIO
v. RESET
vi. SUBMIT
vii. TEXT

11.4 Submit and Reset

All forms require a SUBMIT and RESET button. These produce a button on the screen which the user can click on to transfer data on the form to the server program. While RESET clears the any data entered on the form.

Example 2

```
<HTML>
 <HEAD><!—Example of submit and reset-->
```

```
 </HEAD>
<BODY>
   <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION="location and file name">
This is my form!
<input type=submit value="send information" name="submit"> <br>
<input type=reset value="clear the form" name="reset"
   </FORM>
</BODY>
</HTML>
```

11.5 Checkbox Fields

If the <INPUT> element has the attribute set to CHECKBOX then a checkbox field is generated. A checkbox can take the following attribute:

i. NAME is the unique name of the checkbox field.
ii. VALUE the data sent to the program is contained within the VALUE attribute.
iii. CHECKED is used to set whether a checkbox is selected.

Example 3

```
<HTML>
 <HEAD><!—Example of checkbox-->
 </HEAD>
<BODY>
   <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION="location and file name">What do
you think about forms<p>
<input type=checkbox Name=Fun value=Y>
This course is fun <p>
<input type=checkbox Name=Tutor value=Y CHECKED>
The tutor is great<BR>
<input type=checkbox Name=Home value=Y>
I want to go home<BR>
<input type=Submit value="send information"> <BR>
<input type=Reset value="clear form">
   </FORM>
</BODY>
</HTML>
```

11.6 Radio Button Fields

If the input element has the attribute set to RADIO a radio button field is generated. RADIO is used when you wish to accept a single value from a set of alternatives. It takes the attributes, NAME, VALUE, CHECKED.

Example 4

```
<HTML>
 <HEAD> <!—Example of radio button-->
 </HEAD>
<BODY>
   <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION="location and file name">What
What is your favourite colour <p>
<INPUT TYPE=RADIO NAME=COLOUR value=RED> Red  <BR>
<INPUT TYPE=RADIO NAME=COLOUR value=GREEN> Green  <BR>
```

```
<INPUT TYPE=RADIO NAME=COLOUR value=BLUE> Blue <BR>
<INPUT TYPE=RADIO NAME=COLOUR value=YELLOW> Yellow<BR>
<INPUT TYPE=RADIO NAME=COLOUR value=WHITE> White<BR>
<INPUT TYPE=SUBMIT VALUE="send information"> <BR>
        <INPUT TYPE=RESET VALUE="clear form">
           </FORM>
        </BODY>
        </HTML>
```

11.7 Text Fields

Text fields are used when you wish to accept a line of typed text, such as a person's name. A text field takes the attributes; NAME, VALUE, SIZE, MAXLENGTH.

Example 5

```
        <HTML>
          <HEAD> <!—Example of a text field-->
          </HEAD>
        <BODY>
           <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION="location and file name">
             Please enter your name
         <p>
<INPUT TYPE=TEXT NAME=NAME SIZE=30>
  <BR>
<INPUT TYPE=SUBMIT VALUE="send information"> <BR>
        <INPUT TYPE=RESET VALUE="clear form">
           </FORM>
        </BODY>
        </HTML>
```

11.8 Password Fields

These are identical to text field, except the text is displayed as **** as it is entered.

Example 6

```
        <HTML>
          <HEAD> <!—Example of a text field-->
          </HEAD>
        <BODY>
           <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION="location and file name">
             Please enter your name
         <p>
<INPUT TYPE=PASSWORD NAME=NAME SIZE=30>
  <BR>
<INPUT TYPE=SUBMIT VALUE="send information"> <BR>
        <INPUT TYPE=RESET VALUE="clear form">
           </FORM>
        </BODY>
</HTML>
```

11.9 Hidden Fields

Hidden fields are used to embed data into a form without the user being aware of it.

11.10 Text Area Fields

The <TEXTAREA>…</TEXTAREA> element is used to enable a user enter in more than one line of text. It takes three attributes i.e, NAME, ROWS and COLS.

Example 7

```
<HTML>
  <HEAD> <!—Example of a textarea field-->
  </HEAD>
<BODY>
    <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION="location and file name">

 <TEXTAREA NAME=MESSAGE ROWS=5 COLS=50>
Please enter your message here!
 </TEXTAREA>
<BR>
<INPUT TYPE=SUBMIT VALUE="send information">
<BR>
<INPUT TYPE=RESET VALUE="clear form">
    </FORM>
</BODY>
</HTML>
```

11.11 Menu Fields

Pull down menus can be created through the open element <SELECT>…</SELECT>. Every option in this list is defined using a <OPTION> element. The <SELECT> element can take the attributes MULTIPLE, NAME, SIZE.

Example 8

```
<HTML>
  <HEAD> <!—Example of  MENU field-->
  </HEAD>
<BODY>
    <FORM METHOD=POST ACTION="location and file name">
   Please select your favourite colours:
<BR>
 <SELECT NAME=MENU MULTIPLE SIZE=5>
<OPTION > Red
<OPTION > White
<OPTION SELECTED > Orange
<OPTION > Blue
<OPTION > Yellow
<OPTION > Green
</SELECT>
<BR>
<INPUT TYPE=SUBMIT VALUE="send information">
<BR>
<INPUT TYPE=RESET VALUE="clear form">
    </FORM>
</BODY>
</HTML>
```

11.12 Exercise

Write an HTML code to design the following information;

i. Are you a vegetarian or a non-vegetarian?
    - Vegetarian
    - Non-vegetarian

ii. What is your profession?
    - Teaching
    - Research
    - Medicine
    - Engineering
    - Clerical
    - Business
    - Other

iii. Type your comments on our food items. (use textarea field)